Work From Home Policy

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Owner	Head of Human Resources, NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.
Applicability	All employees on the payroll of NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. at Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad and Gurugram offices
HR Contact	hr-helpdesk@novatech.example, ext. 4000

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1. Purpose and Scope [ALL EMPLOYEES]

1.1 Purpose

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. ("NovaTech", "the Company") follows a hybrid work model. This policy explains who can work from home (WFH), how often, how to get approval, what is expected while working remotely, and what support the Company provides. The aim is to give employees flexibility while protecting team collaboration, client delivery and data security.

1.2 Applicability

- This policy applies to all permanent employees from L1 to L7+.
- Fixed-term employees are covered for the period of their contract.
- Interns, trainees on stipend and third-party contractors are **not** covered. Their work arrangements are governed by their agreements.
- WFH is a facility offered by the Company. It is not a right and can be changed or withdrawn as per this policy.

1.3 Definitions

- **Hybrid Model:** A work pattern with 3 days in the office and 2 days WFH in a week.
- **Anchor Days:** Tuesday and Thursday. Employees on the hybrid model must be in the office on these days, unless the Company has declared a WFH advisory (Section 9).
- **Core Hours:** 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM, Monday to Friday, when every employee must be available.
- **Fully Remote Employee:** An employee approved to work from home on all working days under Section 2.3.
- **HRMS:** The Company's HR Management System.
- **Confirmed Employee:** An employee who has completed probation and received a written confirmation letter.
- **Working Day:** Monday to Friday, excluding public holidays. Standard hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM (see the Leave Policy, Section 1.3).

2. Work Models [ALL EMPLOYEES]

2.1 Standard Hybrid Model

1. Eligible employees work 3 days in the office and up to 2 days from home each week.

2. Tuesday and Thursday are mandatory office days. The third office day is decided with the reporting manager at the start of each month.
3. WFH days cannot be carried forward to another week or month. Unused WFH days lapse and are not compensated in any form.
4. An employee cannot take both Monday and Friday as WFH days in the same week more than twice in a calendar month.
5. In a week with one public holiday (4 working days), a maximum of 1 WFH day is allowed. In a week with two or more public holidays, no WFH days are allowed unless the manager approves.

2.2 Office-Only Roles

Some roles must be performed from the office, such as IT desk support, facilities, reception, security, and roles on a shift roster. Such roles are identified in the offer letter or the role description and are not eligible for the hybrid model, except as described in Section 3.3.

2.3 Fully Remote Exceptions

Fully remote work is allowed only in the following cases and needs the approval described in Section 4.3.

Category	Condition	Maximum Duration
Remote-first role	Role was approved as remote at the time of hiring	Duration of role, reviewed every 12 months
Medical condition	Medical certificate from a registered practitioner showing that travel or office presence is not advisable	90 days, renewable once
Reasonable accommodation	Employee with a disability, where office access cannot be adjusted	As recommended by HR, reviewed every 6 months
Temporary relocation	Documented family or personal circumstance, such as caring for a seriously ill parent or spouse	6 months

Conditions for fully remote employees:

- The number of fully remote employees in a department must not exceed **5%** of the department's headcount.

- Fully remote employees must visit their base office for at least **4 working days per quarter** for team meetings and reviews. Travel costs for these visits are reimbursed as per the Travel Policy (NT-FIN-POL-001), Section 3.
- Fully remote status is reviewed every 6 months and can be withdrawn with 30 days' notice.

3. Eligibility [ALL EMPLOYEES]

3.1 Eligibility by Level and Tenure

Employee Category	Day 1 to Day 90	Day 91 to Confirmation	After Confirmation
L1 to L2 (Associate)	Not eligible	1 day per week	2 days per week
L3 to L4 (Senior)	Not eligible	1 day per week	2 days per week
L5 to L6 (Lead/Manager)	Not eligible	2 days per week	2 days per week
L7+ (Director/VP)	Not eligible	2 days per week	No weekly limit, but at least 12 office days per month

The first 90 days are for onboarding, training and building team relationships. All new employees must work from the office during this period.

3.2 Eligibility by Department

Department	WFH Rules
Engineering	Standard hybrid. Employees on client projects that require office-only work are excluded (see 11.5).
Product	Standard hybrid.
HR	Standard hybrid. At least 2 HR Helpdesk staff must be in the office on every working day.
Finance	Standard hybrid. No WFH during the **last 3 working days and first 2 working days** of every month (month-end close), and during quarter-end and audit weeks notified by the Finance Head.

Department	WFH Rules
Sales	Standard hybrid. Client-visit days count as office days. WFH is subject to the client calendar and the sales target review.
Operations	Maximum 1 WFH day per week for desk-based roles. Roster-based and on-site roles are not eligible.

3.3 General Conditions

1. The employee must have a company laptop, a stable internet connection of at least **25 Mbps download and 5 Mbps upload**, and a quiet workspace.
2. Employees with an open written warning or a performance improvement plan (PIP) are limited to **1 WFH day per week** until the matter is closed.
3. Not more than **50%** of a team may work from home on the same day (see Section 13.3).
4. Employees who move to a new department or office are assessed under the rules of the new department from the date of transfer.

4. Approval Process [ALL EMPLOYEES]

4.1 Regular Hybrid Schedule

1. By the **25th of every month**, the employee must submit the proposed WFH days for the next month in the HRMS under **Apply WFH**.
2. The reporting manager must approve or reject the schedule within **2 working days**.
3. Once approved, the schedule remains valid for the month. Any change needs fresh approval.

4.2 Ad-hoc WFH Requests

- An extra WFH day (beyond the approved schedule) can be requested for personal reasons by L1 to L6 employees for a maximum of **4 days per quarter**.
- The request must be raised by **6:00 PM on the previous working day**. The manager must respond within 1 working day.
- Same-day requests are accepted only for genuine urgent reasons. The employee must get the manager's approval by message or email before 9:30 AM, and must regularise it in the HRMS within 2 working days.
- If the manager does not act within the response time, the request is escalated automatically to the skip-level manager. There is no auto-approval.

- A rejection must include a written reason in the HRMS.

4.3 Fully Remote Requests

1. The employee submits a **Remote Work Request** in the HRMS with supporting documents.
2. Approval order: Reporting Manager, Department Head, HR Business Partner, Head of HR.
3. HR will give a decision within **10 working days**.
4. Approval is valid for the period stated in Section 2.3. HR will record it in the employee's file.

4.4 Rejection and Appeal

An employee whose request is rejected may write to the skip-level manager or to hr-helpdesk@novatech.example (ext. 4000) within 5 working days. HR will respond within 5 working days.

5. Working Hours and Availability [ALL EMPLOYEES]

5.1 Working Hours

- Working hours on WFH days are the same as office days: **9:30 AM to 6:30 PM**, with a lunch break of 1 hour.
- Employees must be available during Core Hours (11:00 AM to 4:00 PM).
- Employees must show their status as "Available" on the Company chat tool during working hours and update it when away from the desk for more than 30 minutes.

5.2 Response Expectations

- Respond to calls and chat messages from the manager and team within **30 minutes** during Core Hours.
- Respond to emails within **4 working hours**, unless the matter is urgent.
- Attend all scheduled meetings. Keep the camera on for client calls and team meetings, unless the meeting organiser says otherwise.

5.3 Overtime and Disconnecting

- WFH does not create an expectation of work after 6:30 PM. Managers must not schedule routine meetings after 6:30 PM or before 9:30 AM.

- Work on weekends or public holidays needs written approval from the manager in advance. Comp-off rules apply as per the Leave Policy (NT-HR-POL-001), Section 3.8.

5.4 Leave on a WFH Day

An employee who is unwell on a WFH day must apply for Sick Leave. WFH is not a replacement for leave. Medical certificate rules are in the Leave Policy, Section 6.

6. Equipment, Internet and Allowances [ALL EMPLOYEES]

6.1 Company-Provided Equipment

- Every employee receives a company laptop, charger and headset.
- Fully remote employees also receive a 24-inch monitor on loan from the Company.
- Company equipment is for official use only. It must be returned within **7 days** of separation or on request. Unreturned equipment is recovered from the Full and Final settlement as per the Compensation and Payroll Policy (NT-HR-POL-004), Section 6.

6.2 Allowances and Reimbursements

Item	L1 to L2	L3 to L4	L5 to L6	L7+	Frequency and Condition
Ergonomic setup allowance (chair, desk, laptop stand)	INR 8,000	INR 10,000	INR 12,000	INR 15,000	Once every 3 years. Confirmed employees only.
Monthly internet allowance (hybrid)	INR 700	INR 900	INR 1,100	INR 1,300	Paid for months with at least 6 WFH days.
Monthly internet and utility allowance (fully remote)	INR 2,000	INR 2,000	INR 2,000	INR 2,000	Flat amount for each month of approved remote work.
Co-working space (internet or power failure)	INR 500 per day	INR 500 per day	INR 500 per day	INR 500 per day	Actuals, maximum 3 days per quarter.

6.3 Claim Rules

1. Ergonomic setup claims must be submitted in the HRMS within **60 days** of purchase with a GST tax invoice in the employee's name.
2. For the internet allowance, the employee must submit a copy of the first internet bill. After that, a self-declaration is needed once a year.
3. Allowances are paid with the monthly salary and are subject to tax as per applicable law.
4. Allowances are paid pro rata and are not paid for months when the employee is on LOP for more than 10 days.

5. If an employee resigns within 12 months of receiving the setup allowance, the full amount is recovered. If the employee resigns between 12 and 24 months, 50% is recovered.
6. The Company does not reimburse mobile bills, electricity (except as in the fully remote row), furniture other than listed above, or home renovation.

7. Data Security and VPN Rules [ALL EMPLOYEES]

7.1 Mandatory Rules

1. Connect to the Company VPN before accessing any internal system, code repository, client environment or file share.
2. Use only the company laptop for work. Personal devices may be used only for email and chat through the Company's mobile device management app. Source code, client data and personal data of employees must never be stored on personal devices.
3. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) must be enabled on all work accounts.
4. The laptop screen must lock automatically after **5 minutes** of inactivity. Lock the screen whenever you leave your desk.
5. Install operating system and security updates within **7 days** of release.
6. Use a password-protected home Wi-Fi network with WPA2 or WPA3 security. Change the default router password.
7. Do not work on Confidential or client-restricted data from cafés, airports, co-working spaces or other public places. Public Wi-Fi may be used only with the VPN switched on, and only for non-confidential tasks.
8. Family members, friends or visitors must not see the screen or use the company laptop.
9. Do not print Confidential documents, take screenshots of client systems, or save files to personal email, personal cloud storage or USB drives.

7.2 Reporting Incidents

- Report a lost or stolen laptop, suspected phishing, malware or any data leak to it-security@novatech.example or ext. 4500 within **2 hours** of noticing it.
- Delay in reporting is treated as a separate violation.

7.3 Client-Specific Rules

Some clients have extra conditions, such as office-only access or restrictions on location. These client conditions override this policy. Refer to the Information Security Policy (NT-IT-POL-001), Section 4, for details.

8. Attendance Tracking [ALL EMPLOYEES]

8.1 Marking Attendance

1. The employee must mark attendance as **WFH** in the HRMS by **9:45 AM** and check out after 6:30 PM.
2. The VPN login time and chat status are used to verify attendance. The Company does not use keystroke logging or screen recording to monitor employees.
3. A day with no attendance entry is treated as an absence. The employee can regularise it within 2 working days as per the Attendance and Work Hours Policy (NT-HR-POL-002), Section 3.
4. More than 3 regularisations in a month need a written justification from the employee's manager.

8.2 Monthly Reports

HR will share a monthly report with managers showing office days, WFH days and ad-hoc WFH days used. Managers must review it for any pattern of non-compliance.

9. Work From Home During Emergencies and Adverse Weather [ALL EMPLOYEES]

9.1 Company-Declared WFH Advisory

HR may declare a WFH advisory for all employees at an office when:

- Heavy rainfall or waterlogging makes travel unsafe, as per the local administration's alert.
- The Air Quality Index crosses the level at which the local authority restricts outdoor activity (for example, Stage III or IV measures in Gurugram).
- A heat wave, strike, bandh, curfew or public safety situation affects the office location.
- There is a building, power or water failure at the office.

Rules for an advisory:

1. HR will inform employees by email and SMS by **7:00 AM** on the day, or on the evening before when possible.
2. The advisory applies to **all** employees at that office, including probationers and employees in their first 90 days.
3. Days worked from home under an advisory do **not** count towards the weekly WFH limit.

4. Employees must follow the normal working hours and attendance rules.
5. Employees in office-only roles must follow the instructions given in the advisory.

9.2 Individual Disruptions

- If an employee faces a power or internet failure at home, the employee must inform the manager by **10:00 AM**.
- If the issue is not fixed within **2 hours**, the employee must either work from a co-working space (reimbursed as per Section 6.2) or go to the office, or apply for leave for the remaining day.
- Employees must not be marked LOP for a disruption caused by a declared advisory.

9.3 Personal Emergencies

In a personal emergency, such as a medical issue in the family, the manager may approve WFH for up to **3 consecutive working days** under the ad-hoc rule in Section 4.2. For longer periods, see Section 10.1 or Section 2.3.

10. Temporary Work From Another City or Country (Workation) [ALL EMPLOYEES]

10.1 Work From Another City in India

Condition	Rule
Eligibility	Confirmed employees at L1 and above, with a performance rating of "Meets Expectations" or higher
Limit	Up to **15 working days** in a leave year, with a minimum of 3 days at a time
Notice	Request at least **10 working days** in advance
Approval	Reporting manager, then HR Business Partner
Working conditions	Same working hours (IST). Internet of at least 25 Mbps. VPN rules apply.
Costs	Travel, stay and internet at the employee's own cost. No additional allowance is paid.
Not allowed	During project go-live, audit or month-end close, and during the notice period

Family-care WFH from another city, such as a hometown, is covered under this limit. HR may approve up to **10 extra working days** per year on a written request in a documented family emergency.

10.2 Work From Another Country

Working from outside India can create tax, immigration, labour law and data protection issues for both the employee and the Company. Therefore:

1. It is **not allowed by default**.
2. It may be approved only for confirmed employees at **L3 and above**, for a maximum of **10 working days** in a leave year.
3. The request must be made at least **30 calendar days** in advance.
4. Approval is needed from the Department Head, HR Business Partner, Head of HR, Finance and IT Security.
5. The country must be on the approved list published by HR on the intranet. Sanctioned or high-risk countries are never approved.

6. The Company may refuse if the client contract has data location restrictions.
7. All costs are borne by the employee. The employee must hold a valid visa that allows remote work, and the employee is responsible for personal tax consequences.
8. Working from outside India without written approval is a serious violation under Section 12.

10.3 Using Leave with Workation

Leave taken before or after a workation is applied separately as per the Leave Policy. A stay outside India of more than **30 consecutive days** (including leave and weekends) needs a fresh review by HR and Finance, even if the working days are within the limit.

11. Special Cases and Exceptions [ALL EMPLOYEES]

11.1 Probationers with Medical Needs

A probationer with a medical condition may be allowed WFH during the first 90 days with a medical certificate and the HR Business Partner's approval.

11.2 Return From Maternity Leave

Employees returning from Maternity Leave may request WFH for up to **12 weeks** as described in the Leave Policy (NT-HR-POL-001), Section 3.4. This is in addition to the weekly limit in Section 3.1 and is subject to the nature of the role.

11.3 Half-Day Leave on a WFH Day

If an employee takes a half-day leave on a WFH day, the day is still counted as one WFH day.

11.4 Notice Period

During the notice period, WFH is allowed only with the manager's approval. The Company may require the employee to work from the office for the **last 15 days** for knowledge transfer and exit formalities. Refer to the Separation and Exit Policy (NT-HR-POL-005), Section 4.

11.5 Client Projects That Restrict WFH

Employees allocated to projects where the client does not allow remote work must work from the office on all days. This is not a policy violation by the Company. The project manager must inform the employees in writing at the time of allocation.

11.6 Employees Living Far From the Office

Living in a different city does not make an employee eligible for fully remote work. An employee who relocates without approval must still follow the office-attendance rules.

11.7 Shared Workspace and Dependents

An employee who cannot ensure a private workspace (for example, for confidential calls) may be asked by the manager to work from the office on days with confidential meetings.

11.8 Dual Employment

Working for another employer or running a business during working hours, including on WFH days, is not allowed and is treated as serious misconduct under the Code of Conduct Policy (NT-HR-POL-003), Section 7.

12. Policy Violations and Consequences [ALL EMPLOYEES]

12.1 Violation Categories and Action

Violation	First Instance	Repeat Instance
Not available during Core Hours without informing the manager (3 or more times in a month)	Written warning	WFH reduced to 1 day per week for 30 days
Wrong WFH attendance entry or not marking attendance	Verbal counselling, recorded in HRMS	Written warning, then loss of ad-hoc WFH for the quarter
Not coming to office on anchor days without approval	Written warning	WFH suspended for 30 days
Security violation (bypassing VPN, storing data on personal devices, public-place work with Confidential data)	WFH suspended for 90 days and disciplinary action	Disciplinary action up to termination
Working from an unapproved city or country	WFH suspended for 6 months and disciplinary action	Termination
False reimbursement claims or fake documents	Recovery of amount and disciplinary action	Termination

Violation	First Instance	Repeat Instance
Dual employment or moonlighting	Disciplinary action up to termination	Not applicable

12.2 Process

1. HR will investigate and give the employee a chance to explain in writing within 5 working days.
2. Disciplinary action is taken as per the Code of Conduct Policy (NT-HR-POL-003), Section 7.
3. A suspension of WFH does not affect salary, leave or other benefits.
4. Warnings remain active for 12 months from the date of issue.

13. Manager Review Criteria [MANAGER AND HR ONLY]

13.1 Quarterly Review

Managers must review the WFH arrangement of each team member every quarter and record the outcome in the HRMS. The following criteria must be used.

Criterion	Expected Standard	Evidence
Delivery	Meets agreed goals and sprint or project commitments	Project tracker, goal review
Availability	Responds within the times in Section 5.2	Chat records, missed meetings log
Office attendance	100% presence on anchor days unless approved	HRMS monthly report
Collaboration	No unresolved feedback about communication or teamwork	Peer and stakeholder feedback
Compliance	No open security or conduct violation	IT Security and HR records
Performance rating	At least "Meets Expectations"	Latest appraisal

13.2 Decisions After Review

- **All criteria met:** WFH continues without change.

- **One criterion not met:** Discuss with the employee and set a 30-day improvement plan. WFH continues.
- **Two or more criteria not met, or a PIP is active:** WFH may be reduced to 1 day per week after informing the HR Business Partner.
- A manager must not withdraw WFH for personal reasons, gender, marital status, age, disability, or because of a leave or grievance by the employee.

13.3 Team Planning

1. Not more than **50%** of the team may be on WFH on any one day.
2. Rotate WFH days fairly. Do not give the same people the preferred days every time.
3. Judge employees by outcomes and not by hours of online presence.
4. Include remote participants fully in meetings, and share notes and decisions in writing.
5. Keep at least **2 working days** for the team to be together in the office each week (anchor days).

13.4 Records

Managers must keep records of approvals, rejections and review notes in the HRMS. HR will audit these records every quarter.

14. Exception Handling and Escalation Matrix [MANAGER AND HR ONLY]

14.1 Approval of Exceptions

No manager can grant an exception on their own authority. Exceptions must be approved as follows and recorded in the HRMS.

Situation	First Level	Second Level	Final Approver
Ad-hoc WFH beyond 4 days per quarter	Reporting Manager	HR Business Partner	HR Business Partner
WFH for a probationer in the first 90 days (medical)	HR Business Partner	Head of HR	Head of HR
Fully remote request	Department Head	HR Business Partner	Head of HR
Fully remote above the 5% department limit	Head of HR	Chief Operating Officer	Chief Operating Officer

Situation	First Level	Second Level	Final Approver
Workation in India above 15 days	HR Business Partner	Head of HR	Head of HR
Work from another country	Department Head	HR Business Partner and Finance	Head of HR
Reimbursement claim after 60 days	HR Business Partner	Finance Controller	Finance Controller
Withdrawal of WFH for a team member	Reporting Manager	HR Business Partner	HR Business Partner

14.2 Escalation Timelines

- Escalated cases must be resolved within **5 working days**.
- If not resolved, HR will inform the Head of HR, who will decide within 3 more working days.

14.3 Handling Security-Related Cases

1. IT Security will inform HR within 24 hours of a confirmed security violation on a WFH day.
2. HR will suspend the WFH facility immediately, pending investigation, where the risk to Company or client data is high.
3. Records of exceptions and violations will be kept for **7 years**.

15. Frequently Asked Questions [ALL EMPLOYEES]

Q1. I joined 2 months ago. Can I work from home? No. The first 90 days are office-only. Exceptions are only for medical reasons with HR approval (see Section 11.1) or when HR declares a WFH advisory (Section 9).

Q2. I am a confirmed L3 employee. How many days can I work from home? Two days per week, as per Section 3.1. Tuesday and Thursday are mandatory office days.

Q3. Can I save my unused WFH days and use 4 days next week? No. WFH days cannot be carried forward (see Section 2.1).

Q4. What is the internet allowance for a Level L5 hybrid employee? INR 1,100 per month, paid for months with at least 6 WFH days (see Section 6.2).

Q5. HR has declared a rain advisory. Will it count as one of my 2 WFH days? No. Days worked from home under an advisory do not count towards your weekly limit (see Section 9.1).

Q6. Can I work from my hometown for two weeks? Yes, if you are a confirmed employee with a "Meets Expectations" rating or higher. You may use up to 15 working days a year within India with 10 working days' notice (see Section 10.1).

Q7. Can I work from abroad while on holiday? Not without approval. It is allowed only for L3 and above, for up to 10 working days a year, with 30 days' notice and approval from several teams (see Section 10.2). Working abroad without approval is a serious violation.

Q8. My home internet is down. What should I do? Inform your manager by 10:00 AM. If it cannot be fixed within 2 hours, work from a co-working space (INR 500 per day, maximum 3 days a quarter), come to the office or apply for leave (see Section 9.2).

Q9. Am I allowed to use my personal laptop for client work? No. Only the company laptop may be used for work. A personal phone may be used for email and chat through the Company's mobile device management app (see Section 7.1).

Q10. My manager rejected my WFH request. What can I do? The manager must give a written reason. If you disagree, write to your skip-level manager or hr-helpdesk@novatech.example (ext. 4000) within 5 working days (see Section 4.4).

16. Related Policies [ALL EMPLOYEES]

- Leave Policy (NT-HR-POL-001)
- Attendance and Work Hours Policy (NT-HR-POL-002)
- Code of Conduct Policy (NT-HR-POL-003)
- Compensation and Payroll Policy (NT-HR-POL-004)
- Separation and Exit Policy (NT-HR-POL-005)
- Information Security Policy (NT-IT-POL-001)
- Travel Policy (NT-FIN-POL-001)

17. Revision History

Version	Date	Description of Change	Author	Approved By
v2024.1	1 April 2024	First issue of the hybrid work model (3 days office, 2 days WFH)	HR Policy Team	Head of HR

Version	Date	Description of Change	Author	Approved By
v2025.1	1 January 2025	Added workation within India and the 5% limit for fully remote roles	HR Policy Team	Head of HR
v2026.1	1 January 2026	Revised allowance amounts, added weather and AQI advisories, rules for work from another country, and manager review criteria	HR Policy Team	Head of HR